

Session 18: Partnering with Others to Sell Your Products

Key Points...

1. Partnering with others gives you massive leverage.
 - The bottom line is that there are many businesses that have already invested time, energy and money to find YOUR customer.
 - By partnering with these companies and getting access to their customers, you can "leap frog" the Marketing process.
2. Who has already done the work to find YOUR customer?
 - Constantly be hunting for companies that have customers like yours.
 - Don't be concerned if they seem "competitive" because competitors need each other to survive.
3. What does your customer do before and after your product?
 - Consider what your Customers do right before and right after they buy your Product.
 - Where would you likely find someone shopping right before and right after they are a great customer for you?
4. Identify your partner's biggest challenges and frustrations.
 - Treat Partners like you would treat Customers - in other words, GET INSIDE THEIR HEADS.
 - Identify fears, frustrations, desires & aspirations of Partners - then ask yourself how you could help solve them.
5. Offer Value, Advice... and especially Marketing Advice
 - Potential Partners are approached all day long by people who want them to make offers to their Customers.
 - Instead of approaching with the "give me" attitude, instead offer valuable advice - especially MARKETING advice.
 - "I think I have an idea of how you can make more money with your existing stuff"
 - It might take you several tries before you get in the door.
6. Create tools to help your partners succeed.
 - The more "proven" your suggestions, the better - so test, systemize, and TRACK.
 - Show potential Partners what you have in mind for a Partnership, and how it worked.
 - Share your vision for how you think it could help them and their customers "above and beyond."
7. Be Ultra Professional:
 - Keep your word.
 - Always be on time.
 - Always pay on time.
 - Keep Partners in the loop in you have problems, delays or other issues.
 - In other words, treat them like a PARTNER.